

paid attention to the evidence available in his day, he could not have perpetrated such an injustice.

Those familiar with my work know that I began by using **f**¹⁸ instead of **K**^r, because minuscule 18 is the family member with the smallest number. I then switched to **f**³⁵ for the following reasons: 1) although 18 is sometimes a purer representative of the texttype than is minuscule 35, in the Apocalypse 18 defects to another type, while 35 remains true [both MSS contain the whole NT]; 2) while 18 is dated to the **XIV** century, 35 is dated to the **XI**, thus giving the lie, all by itself, to von Soden's dictum that **K**^r was created in the **XII** century. Further, if 35 is a copy, not a new creation, then its exemplar had to be older, and so on.

After doing a complete collation of 1,389 MSS that contain the whole *Pericope Adulterae* (there were a few others that certainly contain the pericope but could not be collated because the microfilm was illegible), Maurice Robinson concluded:

Based upon the collated data, the present writer is forced to reverse his previous assumptions regarding the development and restoration/preservation of the Byzantine Textform in this sense: although textual transmission itself is a process, it appears that, for the most part, the lines of transmission remained separate, with relatively little mixture occurring or becoming perpetuated...

Certainly, all the types of PA text are distinct, and reflect a long line of transmission and preservation in their separate integrities... ..

It thus appears that the Byzantine minuscule MSS preserve lines of transmission which are not only independent but which of necessity had their origin at a time well before the 9th century.¹

¹ "Preliminary Observations regarding the *Pericope Adulterae* based upon Fresh Collations of nearly all Continuous-Text Manuscripts and over One Hundred Lectionaries", presented to the Evangelical Theological Society, Nov., 1998, pp. 12-13. However, I have received the following clarification from Maurice Robinson: "I would request that if my name gets cited in regard to your various **K**^r or **M**⁷ articles that you make it clear that I do not concur with your assessment of **K**^r or **M**⁷. This is particularly the case with the "Preliminary Considerations regarding the *Pericope Adulterae*" article; it should not be used to suggest that I consider the **M**⁷ line or **K**^r text to be early. This would be quite erroneous, since I hold with virtually all others that **K**^r/**M**⁷ are indeed late texts that reflect re-censional activity beginning generally in the 12th century (perhaps with 11th century base exemplars, but nothing earlier)." [Assuming that he was sincere when he wrote that article, I wonder what new evidence came his way that caused him to change his mind—